

EXPLOITED VULNERABILITY ADVISORY: CVE-2026-76461

Summary

CVE-2026-76461 in Cisco Secure Email Gateway is being actively exploited in the wild. A vulnerability in the email parsing of Cisco AsyncOS Software for Cisco Secure Email Gateway could allow an unauthenticated, remote attacker to execute arbitrary commands with root privileges on the underlying operating system.

This vulnerability is due to insufficient validation in the email parsing logic. An attacker could exploit this vulnerability by sending a crafted email message that contains malicious SQL statements through an affected device. A successful exploit could allow the attacker to execute arbitrary SQL statements, leading to command execution with root privileges on the underlying operating system. CISA requires federal remediation by 2026-09-17; under the CRA, exploitation of an affected product must be reported within 24 hours.

What we know

- **CVE:** CVE-2026-76461
- **Affected:** Cisco Secure Email Gateway
- **Exploitation:** Actively exploited, added to CISA KEV on 2026-09-14
- **Severity:** CVSS 9.8 Critical, Network-exploitable, no privileges required, no user interaction (CVSS:3.1/AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H)
- **Weakness:** CWE-89

Recommended action

Patch CVE-2026-76461 by 2026-09-17. If you cannot patch immediately, restrict network access to the affected service now (segment it, put it behind a VPN, or take it offline) until you can patch. If you ship an affected product, be ready to file the CRA 24-hour report the moment you find it exploited.

Sources: CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities, NIST NVD. Public data; an advisory of active exploitation, not an incident report. Verify applicability to your estate before acting.